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HEADQUARTERS  
SUB-REGION FRANKFURT  
COUNTER INTELLIGENCE CORPS REGION III

APD 757

IIS-FM-6771

20 January 1948

SUMMARY REPORT OF INVESTIGATION

SUBJECT: Egwin O. LEIBER (German Aircraft Engineer) Cross Reference: Aircraft Designer

Case Classification: Abduction

1. Reason for Investigation:

Information was obtained that Egwin O. LEIBER, who was reported abducted from the US Zone, had been released by the MVD and had returned to FRANKFURT (L51/M67).

2. Synopsis of Previous Investigation:

An interview with Ilse LEIBER, wife of Subject, revealed that her husband had been arrested while attempting to return to the US Zone on or about 2 November 1947. Subject's wife was arrested on 11 November 1947 and questioned as to her husband's occupation. She was released the same day and told to remain in GOTHHA (M51/J06). She disregarded the order and came to FRANKFURT.

3. Synopsis of Present Investigation:

a. An interview with Subject revealed that he left FRANKFURT on 10 October 1947 to take a business trip to CHEMNITZ (M51/X56). Subject stopped in GOTHHA to visit his wife. After his arrival in GOTHHA he noticed that his actions were being observed by German agents of the MVD. He left GOTHHA and proceeded to KRFURT (M51/J36) but returned to GOTHHA several days later. He left GOTHHA again on 5 November 1947 to return to FRANKFURT. At WARTHA (L51/H76) he was arrested by three (3) German policemen, taken from the train to Police Headquarters and then turned over to the Soviet authorities in EISENHACH (L51/H76). There he was subjected to a short interrogation of approximately twenty (20) minutes. Subject was then taken to GOTHHA by automobile and placed in a MVD jail on Steinmuhlen Allee. Here he was relieved of all his papers and personal belongings, including two (2) suitcases, in which he had some professional papers.

b. At 2200 hours on 5 November 1947 he was interrogated by a Soviet Lt. Colonel in uniform. Subject attempted to learn the officer's name several times but was unsuccessful. During this interrogation Subject was asked if he was a technical specialist, to which he replied that he was an aircraft engineer. He was asked for a short autobiography (Lebenslauf), which he gave them. He was then

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asked if he knew it was illegal to possess technical papers. Subject did not answer. Until this time Subject did not know the reason for his arrest. This interrogation lasted approximately thirty (30) minutes. The Lt. Colonel was very polite during the entire proceedings.

c. The following day, 6 November 1947, he had to dictate his life story in detail, which required the entire day. His Lebenslauf was then written in Russian and Subject was required to sign it regardless of whether or not he understood it.

d. Subject was again interrogated on 14 November 1947 by the same Lt. Colonel, this time in the presence of several other Soviet officer, one of whom was a very good interpreter. This interrogation lasted about two and a half (2½) hours. The Lt. Colonel did not seem to believe the reason Subject gave for living in the US Zone, when his home was really in GOTHA. During this time he was told that he would be assigned to work in a Russian company. He was asked what type of work his former associates were doing at present and where they were living. Subject mentioned several associates who are at present working in Russia or the Russian Zone. He mentioned one Dr. Alex LIPPISCH, who is working at Wright Field, DAYTON, Ohio. Subject was then offered a job, told that he would have nothing to worry about and that he would have everything he would need for himself and his family. Other questions were asked about generalities in the US Zone. From this time until his release he was not questioned again.

e. During the time he was held Subject was not required to do any work. He was kept in a small room without furniture in the cellar of the building. As a daily ration he received two hundred fifty (250) grams of bread, one half liter (½) of black Ersatz coffee and three fourth (¾) liter of cabbage soup with a few potatoes. In a period of six (6) weeks Subject lost fourteen (14) pounds.

f. On 20 December 1947 Subject was taken to the Chief of the MVD and was told that he was going to be released. He was told to stay in GOTHA and that several technical specialists would soon visit him to decide where he would be assigned for work. Subject did no more than agree to wait. He was then given six (6) pounds of pork, one (1) loaf of bread, ten (10) pounds of flour, five (5) pounds of sausage and two hundred (200) M. whereupon he was released and taken to his home in an automobile.

g. From 20 December 1947 until 5 January 1948 Subject remained in GOTHA waiting for an opportune time to leave the Russian Zone. On 6 January 1948 Subject left GOTHA and returned to FRANKFURT.

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h. Egwin O. LEIBER was born [REDACTED] he is 5'7½" tall, weight 135 lbs, black hair, brown eyes, mole on left side of nose. Subject worked in GOTHA for the Gotha Waggon Fabrik, Aircraft Section, from 1935 until 1940. He designed two (2) airplanes during this time, the GO 150 and the GO 243. From 1940 until 1945 Subject worked in KEMPURT for a Special Aircraft Fabrik as chief of construction. LEIBER is at present living at [REDACTED]

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4. Undeveloped Leads:

There are no undeveloped leads at present.

5. Agent's Notes and Comments:

None

6. Recommendations:

It is recommended that LEIBER be interviewed by G-2 Technical Intelligence.

Evaluation: F-2.

APPROVED:

*Marvin L. Rissinger*  
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Special Agent, CIO  
Operations

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IMP AND PERS INDEX

LEIBER, Egwin O.

NVD

LEIBER, Ilse

LIPPISCH, Dr. Alex

WRIGHT FIELD

GO 160

GO 243

Gotha Waggon Fabrik, Aircraft Section

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